

platform to the whole Web. Basically, any application that speaks the open graph protocol can speak to the Facebook platform.

Integrating your Web app with the time-line

In case you're wondering why and how Facebook can be integrated into your Web app, here's the answer. Basically, the new platform allows Facebook to integrate inseparably, with the help of various plug-ins like the *Login* button, *Like* button, and even the open graph. These enable ease of development, and simplicity in managing the users of your Web app. They will also help you increase the use of the application, with the help of free social media publicity, which is based on referrals being made from person-to-person. Remember, you are much more likely to use an app if your friends use it too. Some of the important technologies and tools that you'll be using are the Facebook SDK and the Graph API. This is something that we won't be covering in this article; you'll have to look it up in the relevant documentation. Our motive here is to just highlight how the new platform has brought about changes that can be reflected in your application—and not to teach Facebook app development itself.

Getting started

To get started developing applications on Facebook, you need the developer app, which is available at <https://developers.facebook.com/apps>. Next, click the *Create New App* button, and enter the name of your application and the app name-space (Figure 1). The app name-space is



Figure 1: Dialogue box asking for the app name and name-space

something that is used for the open graph, under which all your open graph objects and actions reside. This is why it is something that should be unique for your application. When you've done this, after the security check, you will be led to the basic settings page (Figure 2), where you can configure more details regarding your application. Here you can choose your application domain, and the way in which your app integrates with Facebook. It can either be a website that adds a social layer over it, or an application that resides wholly under the Facebook interface. Either way, you will have to enter the appropriate settings related to your application here.

Apart from this, you can set up an authentication system for your application from the *Auth Dialog* tab (Figure 3), where you can set the headline, description and an explanation for the permissions you ask from the user. A new feature is 'authenticated referrals', where



Figure 2: The basic settings page



Figure 3: The Auth Dialog tab



Figure 4: The Auth Dialog preview

you can set up mandatory and optional permissions for the user, and the *Auth Dialog* will automatically appear when a user is referred to your app. This will allow a user to be automatically logged in to your app. You can see this in the